AI Automation

AI Workflow practice:
Step-by-step build guide

Scaling my avatar

INSTRUCTIONS: How to use this deck

This deck will walk you through how to build an AI-powered workflow step by step, no guessing, no code required.

What to expect:

You'll follow a structured format that guides you through:

- Setting up each tool
- Connecting systems like ChatGPT, or YouTube
- Testing and troubleshooting
- Practicing prompt design and automation logic

What you'll need:

- This deck
- Your no-code tool open (e.g., Make.com or n8n)
- Your tool accounts set up and logged in
- Any scenario-specific templates or assets (e.g., HeyGen)

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WORKFLOW OVERVIEW

Workflow name: Scaling my avatar

What this workflow does:
This automation turns a short script into a talking AI avatar video using HeyGen, then auto-uploads it to YouTube. It's your end-to-end personal content studio!

Problem it solves:
Creating and publishing videos is time-consuming and tool-heavy. This workflow automates the entire process: writing, your own custom avatar generation, and publishing. The goal is to help you scale content with ease.

Objective:
Learn to build a full-stack media workflow by connecting OpenAI, HeyGen, and YouTube, while handling file timing, avatar config, and media upload logic.

Tools Required:

- Make.com
- OpenAI (GPT-4o-mini)
- HeyGen (free trial version, with avatar - custom or stock)
- YouTube (connected via OAuth2)

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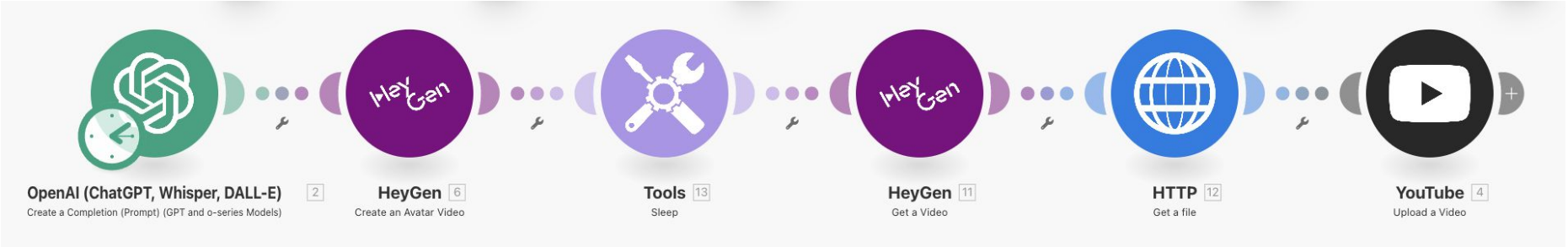
AUTOMATION SNAPSHOT



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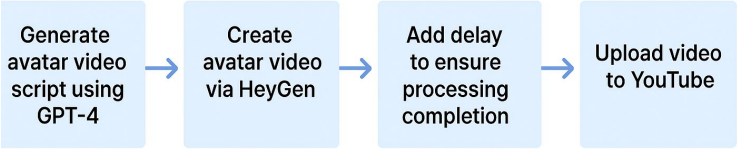
PROCESS MAP

Here is a simplified process map for the workflow you will build in Make.com. Remember, once you've visualized your process, you're set to build your automation.

SCALING MY AVATAR WORKFLOW



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Get started with building your automation

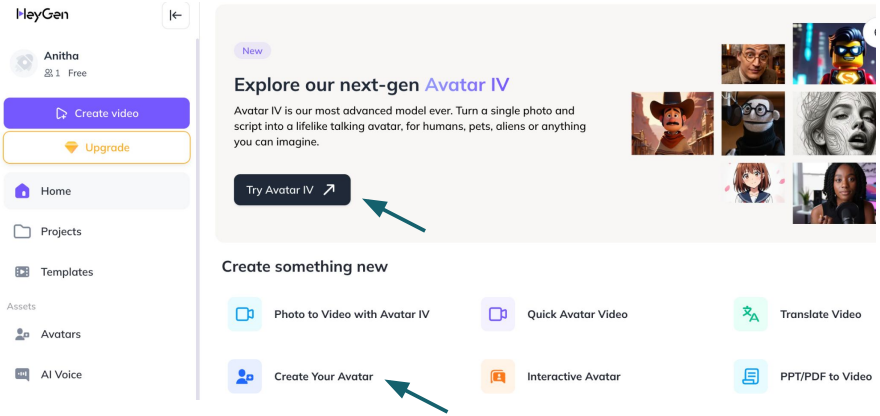
Go to the next slide to get started with step-by-step instructions for building your automation

Let's Get Shredded

STEP 1: Set up your avatar in HeyGen

Before you can generate avatar videos, you'll need to create your own talking avatar in HeyGen using their **Avatar IV** feature.

1. Go to https://www.heygen.com.
2. Click **Sign Up** and create a free account using your Google login or email.
3. Once inside your dashboard, click **Create Avatar** (or go to the **Avatars** tab).
4. Choose the **Avatar IV** option to create a fully animated avatar.
5. Follow the on-screen steps to upload:
   - A **2-minute talking head video** of yourself (neutral background, framing, good lighting)
   - A short **audio sample** (if required—it may use audio from the video itself)
6. Submit and wait for HeyGen to process your avatar (usually under a couple of hours).



Note:
This is a one-time setup. Once your avatar is ready, you'll use it in the automation to generate new videos automatically.

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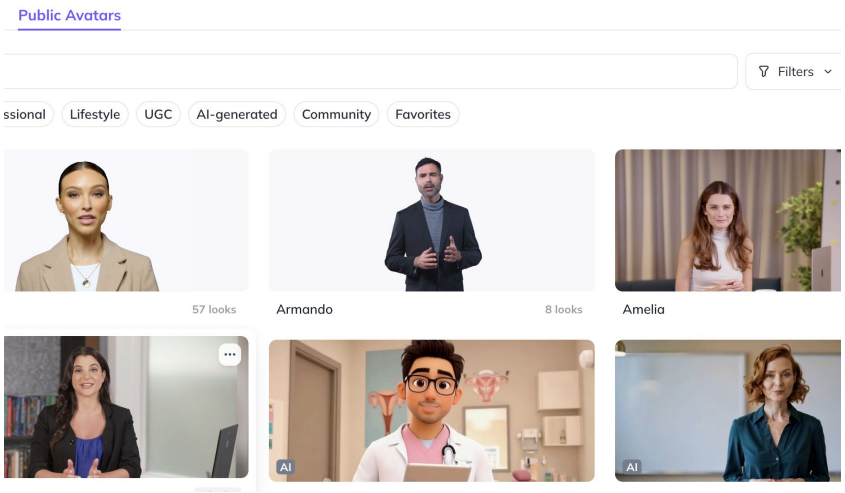
STEP 1: Set up your avatar in HeyGen

Alternate option:

You can also skip the custom avatar and use:

- A **stock avatar** from HeyGen's library
- Or upload a **talking photo** (just a still image of yourself or someone else) which will allow HeyGen to still develop a custom video avatar



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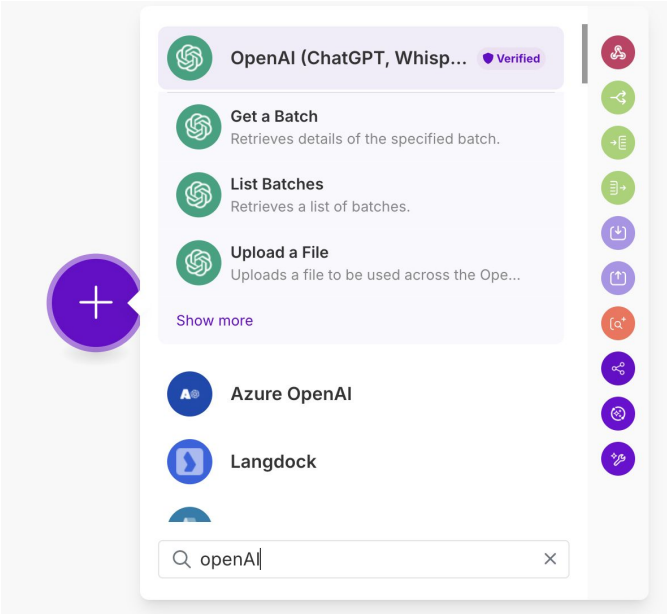
STEP 2: Start building your workflow on Make.com

1. **Log into Make.com**
   - Open Make.com and log in with your credentials (sign up for free if you haven't created one yet).

2. **Create a new scenario**
   - Click on the **Create a new scenario** button from your Make.com dashboard.
   - Give your scenario a name at the top - something like *"Scaling My Avatar".*

3. **Click the "+" to add a module in Make.com**
   - In the search bar, type **OpenAI** and select:
     → **OpenAI > Create Completion (Chat)**
   - Select your **OpenAI connection**
     - Select your Model (Choose "GPT-4o-mini." The API for this course only works with the "GPT-4o-mini" model, other models will give an error.).



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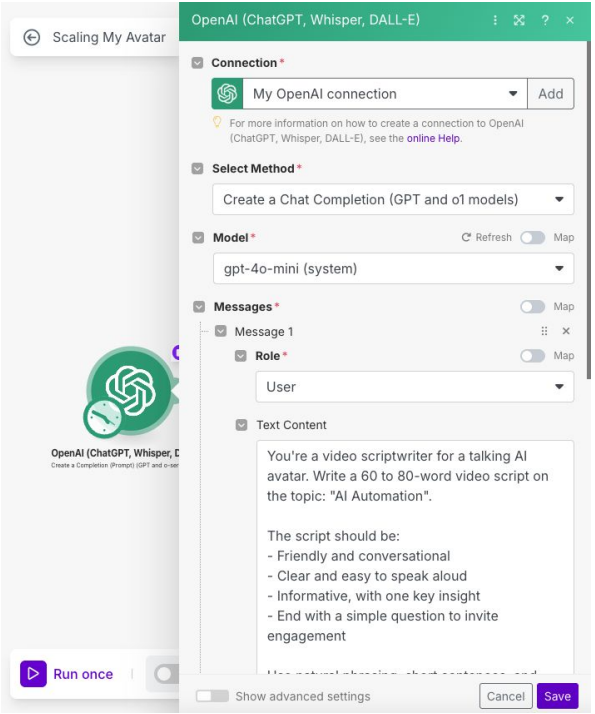
STEP 3: Configure an OpenAI prompt to send a script for your video

4. Within your **OpenAI connection**, configure your prompts to tell AI what to write. Make sure you've selected the 'GPT-4o-mini' model.
   - Click **Add Message** section
   - Set **Role** to **User** and paste this prompt below into **Text Content:** You're a video script writer for a talking AI avatar. Write a 60 to 80-word video script on the topic: "AI Automation". The script should be: - Friendly and conversational - Clear and easy to speak aloud- Informative, with one key insight - End with a simple question to invite engagement. Use natural phrasing, short sentences, and avoid jargon.
   - Hit **Save**.
   - **REMEMBER!** Your script should be short and sweet, you don't want the video to be too long and it would take a long time to generate and upload as your testing your first one, so feel free to refine your prompt.
   - **Tip:** Want to change the topic? Just edit the line: **on the topic: "AI Automation".** You can insert your own subject like "Marketing trends" or "How to use AI for research".



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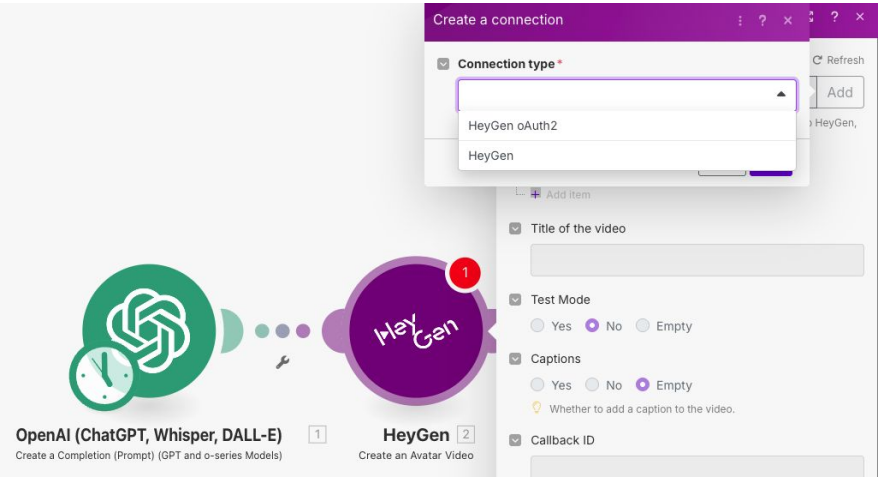
STEP 4: Turn the script into a talking avatar video

Now let's pass your script to HeyGen and turn it into a talking avatar video.

1. Click the **+** to add a new module.
2. In the search bar, type **HeyGen** and select: → **HeyGen > Create an Avatar Video.**
3. Choose your **HeyGen OAuth2 connection** (use the same account where you created your avatar).

Now let's configure the video settings -> **over to the next slide.**



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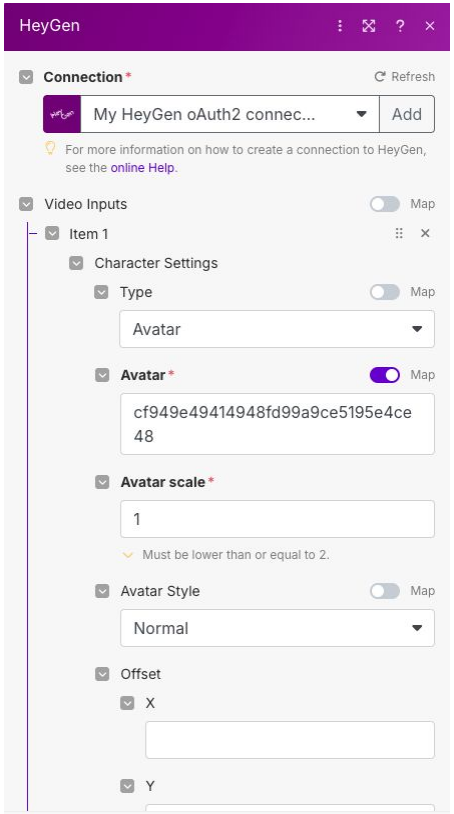
STEP 4: Turn the script into a talking avatar video

Now configure the video settings, starting with character settings:

1. **Character settings:**
   - **Type:** From the dropdown, select **Avatar**.
   - **Avatar:** Click the dropdown and select your avatar (if you've created one with Avatar IV). You should see your avatar ID here.
   - *If you don't see anything, make sure your avatar is published inside HeyGen.*
   - **Avatar Scale:** 1
   - **Avatar Style:** Normal
   - Leave the rest empty/default.



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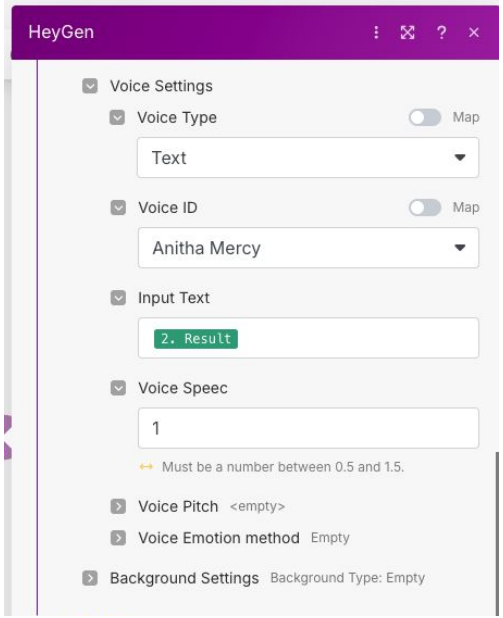
STEP 4: Turn the script into a talking avatar video

Continue with your video settings, now with voice settings.

2. **Voice settings:**
   - **Voice Type:** Text
   - **Voice ID:** Select your voice (*your name should populate there*) from the dropdown
   - **Input Text:** Drag in 2.Result from the OpenAI module
   - **Voice Speed:** 1
   - Leave **Pitch** and **Emotion** blank for now unless you want to customize tone



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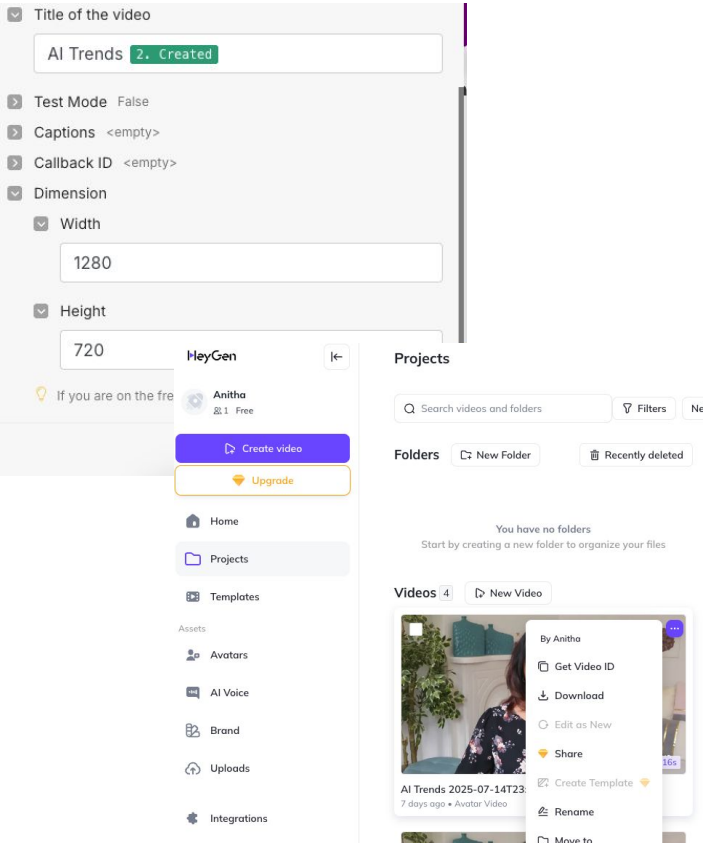
STEP 4: Turn the script into a talking avatar video

Continue to configure the video settings:

3. **Video settings:**
   - Set **Title** to: something like AI Trends - 2.Created by typing the text like “AI Trends” and then Mapping the Date Created from the OpenAI field.
   - Set **Dimensions** to: Width = 1280, Height = 720

NOTE: In case you are not able to map your avatar while configuring the HeyGen module in Make, then you can manually map by copy/pasting the video ID as shown in the screenshot here on the bottom.



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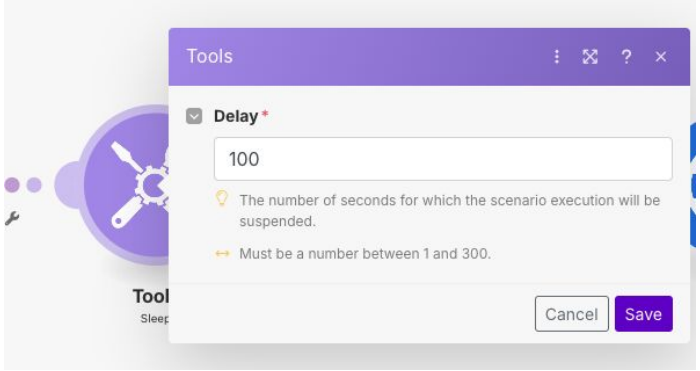
STEP 5: Add a delay before fetching the video

HeyGen needs a little time to process and render your avatar video after you submit the request. Let's add a short delay before we try to fetch it.

1. Click the **+** after the HeyGen module
2. Search for **Tools > Sleep**
   → Select **Function > Sleep**

Now configure it:

- **Duration**: 100
  (This equals 100 seconds. You can increase this later if your video is longer or HeyGen is slower.)



NOTE: Make will move to the next module immediately unless you explicitly tell it to pause. Without this delay, the video may not be ready or a video ID may not have generated when you try to download it.

This is one of those "glue steps" in automation - simple but essential. When working with external APIs like HeyGen, timing matters.

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STEP 6: Fetch the completed video from HeyGen

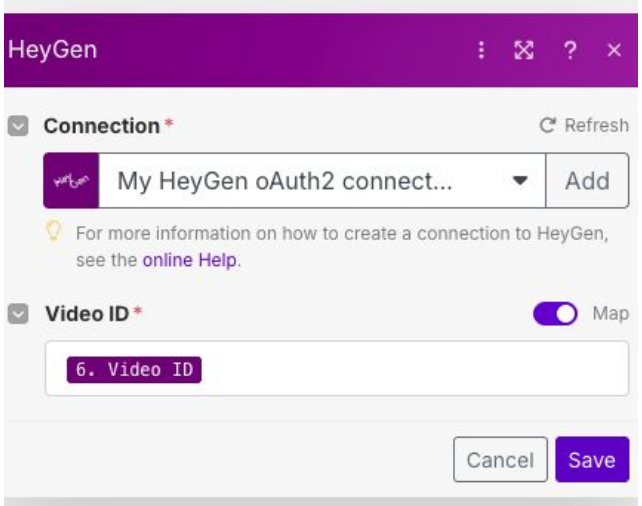
Now that we've given HeyGen enough time to process the video, it's time to fetch the video file URL using its **video ID**.

1. Click the **+** after the Sleep module.
2. Search for **HeyGen > Get a Video** and select it.
3. Choose the same **HeyGen connection** used earlier.

Now fill out the required field:

- **Video ID:** Click into the field, then map the video_id output from the **HeyGen Create Avatar Video** module (the purple one before the sleep module).

  You should see it listed as something like 6.video_id in the mapping popup.



Troubleshooting Reminder:
If you don't see a video_id when mapping, double-check:

- That your HeyGen video module is returning a response
- That your sleep delay was long enough
- That you ran the previous steps at least once (so mapping options appear)

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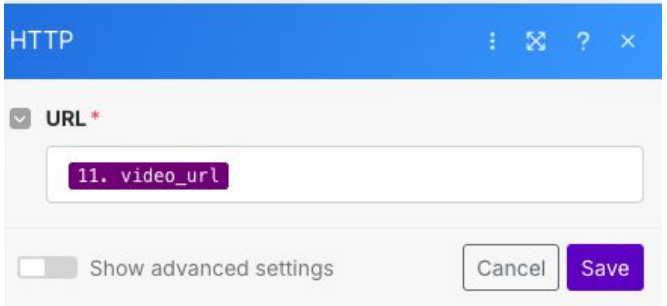
STEP 7: Download the video file using HTTP module

We now have a video URL from HeyGen. Let's download the actual file so we can upload it to YouTube in the next step.

1. Click the **+** after the HeyGen "Get a Video" module
2. Search for **HTTP > Get a File**

Now configure it:

- **URL:** Map the video_url output from the previous HeyGen module
  → Should show up as something like 11.video_url



Why we need this step:
HeyGen gives you a downloadable video URL, but Make.com needs to fetch that file and hold it in memory before it can send it to YouTube.

This is a common "media handoff" pattern. Many AI tools generate downloadable links, but Make requires the HTTP module to pull the actual file data into the flow.

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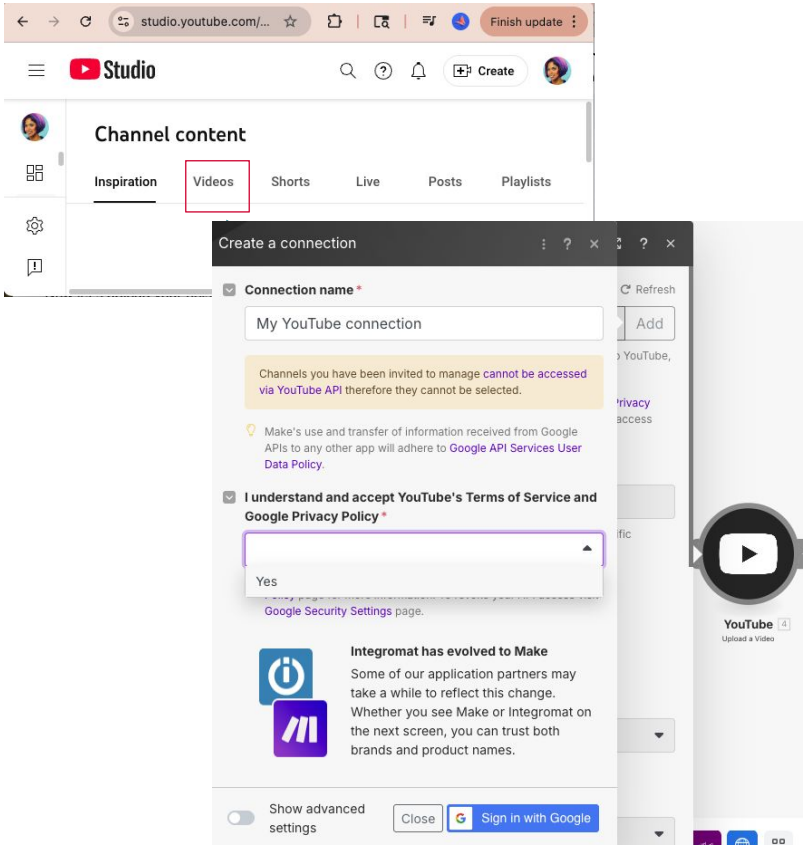
STEP 8: Upload the video to YouTube

Now let's upload your finished avatar video directly to YouTube automatically.

Before you begin: YouTube prerequisites

1. You must have a **YouTube (Google) account** connected to a **YouTube Channel.**
2. Go to https://studio.youtube.com to confirm your channel is set up.
3. In Make.com, let's connect your YouTube account via **OAuth2** (it will prompt you the first time).
4. Accept the permissions to allow Make to upload videos on your behalf. You will do this by creating a new module.
   a. Click the **+** after the HTTP module
   b. Search for: **YouTube > Upload a Video**
   c. Select your connected **YouTube OAuth2 account**



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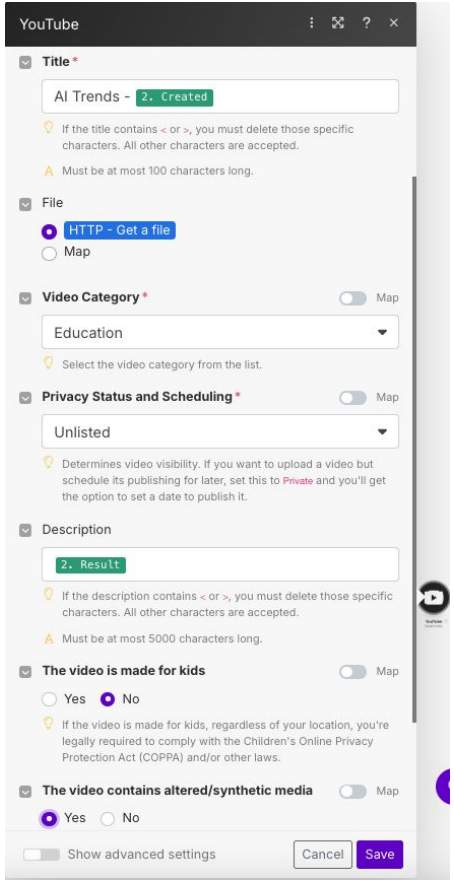
STEP 8: Upload the video to YouTube

Now finish configuring YouTube Module

- **Title:** Use something like AI Trends - 2.Created by mapping the OpenAI **Created** Date field with when it was created to keep tab. You can skip customizing too.
- **File:** Make sure it has **HTTP - Get a File** selected
- **Video Category:** Select **27 - Education** or something relevant
- **Description:** Drag in **result** from the OpenAI module (or write your own summary)
- **Privacy Status:** Choose **unlisted** (you can change it later to public or private)
- **Made for Kids:** No
- **Contains Synthetic Media:** Yes

Hit **Save**.



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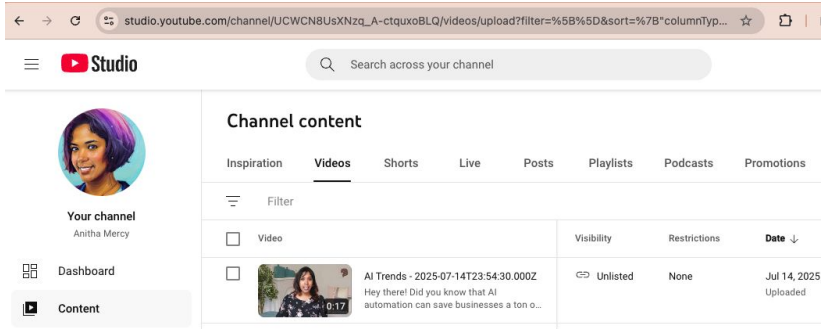
STEP 9: Run and test your workflow

- Don’t forget to **Save** your workflow and give it a name.
- You’ve connected the dots across AI, avatar creation, file processing, and real-world publishing. It’s a full end-to-end automation, script to screen.
- Hit **Run Once** at the bottom of the Make scenario.

-> Watch each module execute step by step. Once it completes:

- Check **YouTube Studio** to see if your video uploaded.
- Check the **HeyGen video status** if no file came through.



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STEP 8: Debug and troubleshoot your workflow

Hope your automation didn't run into errors. If it did, be sure to double-check the connections and mappings we did one more time. This was a lot, so you could have missed something.

- Use **Run History** (clock icon) to step through failed runs.
- If a step turns **red**, click on it to see the exact error.
- Use **Output > Bundles** to preview values coming through each module.

REFLECT

Record your thoughts about this process including what you needed to do to obtain the desired results. Take notes in your study guide to help you document your thoughts along the way.

- What challenges did you face in building your workflow?
- How did the tool integration go?
- What troubleshooting steps did you have to take?
- What did you learn about building AI-powered automations?

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